

OTM 714 – Supply Chain Analytics – Spring 2026

Final Project – Team Assignment

Due May 3, 2026, 11:59pm

The final project for this course is intended to offer you flexibility to explore some aspect of analytics that you find interesting. Given the range of possible projects that would be appropriate, there is not one single format that the project must adhere to. However, in order to provide some guidance, this document outlines the basic requirements, clarifies the timing of deliverables, and provides several examples of possible project orientations.

Deliverable

- You should submit a narrated Powerpoint presentation (or video recording), about 10-15 minutes in length, summarizing the data set, your analysis, and your results. All team members should deliver part of the presentation.

Team composition

- Since I would like you to have freedom to work with people who want to pursue similar interests, you may select your own teams. I would like teams to have 3-4 members. If you would like me to help you form a team, please let me know – I would be happy to do so.

Examples

1. Analysis of a data set (Most common project type)

Using a data set of your choice (e.g., obtained from Kaggle or some other public source), perform some analysis using the techniques we've discussed in class. For example, you might begin by providing some Tableau visualizations illustrating the results of your exploration of the data, indicating some patterns or relationships you chose to explore further. (Make sure there's a point to the visualizations you report – don't just create random visualizations to check a box.) Then apply some techniques like linear regression, logistic regression, random forests, etc. to try to quantify some of those relationships or build a predictive model. Report on what you find. Since you'll be working with data that we're not deeply familiar with, and where we don't know for sure what models might fit well, it's OK if your results are not overwhelmingly positive (great fit, great predictive power, etc.). Just be sure that you articulate reasonable rationale for trying given models or techniques, report your efforts and comment on the results – positive or negative. If appropriate, you might close with some Tableau visualizations to help communicate any results you were able to obtain. For your project to have sufficient depth, you should apply at least two techniques (e.g., linear regression and random forests) to your data set and compare the results. (But only apply techniques that make sense – don't try to apply everything we've discussed in class, because chances are that this won't make sense for a single data set.) The presentation might be structured as: brief problem/data description, rationale (possibly including visualization) for choosing specific techniques or modeling approaches, summary of your analysis and results, any additional comments (additional data you wish you had, questions you had about the data but didn't have answers to, etc.).

2. Exploration of different techniques

While I've tried to expose you to a wide range of analytical techniques, we obviously can't cover everything. You might choose one or a few techniques (Naïve Bayes classification, neural networks, etc.) and provide a brief lesson on the basics of those approaches. The presentation might include: identify the technique(s) you're covering, a brief description of each technique and how it works, an illustration of each technique applied to a data set (preferably the same data set across techniques, if that's appropriate), and comments on the strengths/weaknesses and similarities/differences among the techniques.

3. Analytics within a company.

Some of you might be interested in doing a deeper exploration of the range of analytical techniques being applied within a given company. A project of this type would probably require access to someone inside the company (or direct personal experience), rather than just publicly available news stories. The presentation might briefly describe the company, then go through a few specific types of applications of analytics (from any of the descriptive/predictive/prescriptive dimensions) – describing the types of problems, types of techniques applied, and the kinds of results they've obtained.

The above list is not necessarily exhaustive – if you have an idea outside of these examples, feel free to describe it to me, and I can help you craft it into something you're excited to work on.